

practices that may help conserve things like water and energy. They prevent land, water and air pollution. They do not harm the environment whether in their production, use or disposal. By their usage, most of these products help conserve energy, minimize carbon footprint or the emission of green house gases at the same time and do not lead to an overall increase in the toxicity or pollution. Majority of these products are bio degradable, recyclable or can be composted. Hence, their disposal does not disturb the ecological balance. Many a times, they are made of recycled materials. Since the waste is being diverted to recycled products, there is a substantial decrease in the amount of waste sent to the landfills and incinerators. The demand for such recycled products leads to the completion of the recycling loop, thereby sustaining the recycling industry.

Why buy these products?

Have you looked around lately? The rate at which we are consuming resources is staggering. We are producing goods, using and then discarding them at a break neck speed. If we don't switch to green products, we will soon



be surrounded by pollution and toxins caused by producing, using and disposing these non-green items. Since there would be no demand of recycled items, the recycling industry would come crashing down.

There would be a serious shortage of resources and energy, as much of the same would be wasted in driving energy inefficient equipment and producing new materials and products. Usage of eco-friendly products allows each and every one of us to decrease the negative effect we create by inhabiting this planet.

How to tell if a product is environment friendly?

No, eco friendly products are not all green in color! In order to help customers identify genuinely eco-friendly products, various programs have been set up in collaboration with the respective governments to certify green manufacturers. Some programs use eco labels such as “Energy Star” and “Green Seal” to endorse such products. The “Energy Star” is an international standard for energy efficient consumer products. One such standard is the “Eco

